

"Our nuclear scientists and engineers have done a splendid job and the entire nation has risen to salute their professional excellence, discipline and patriotism. They have had the benefit of being led in the past by great men like Homi Bhabha and Vikram Sarabhai"

— ATAL BIHARI VAJPAYEE,
former PM, in an interview to India Today

advantages accrued over the years. The brief period of discomfort in India-US equations didn't stand in the way of President Bill Clinton's landmark visit to India just two years later in 2000. That successful visit and the US's recognition of India's economic, military and strategic heft led to closer ties and the Indo-US nuclear deal in 2005. That itself, in a chain reaction of sorts, normalised India's civil nuclear energy programme. Operation Shakti thus was an extraordinary game-changer for India.

India now has a nuclear triad (the capability to deliver N-weapons by land, air and sea-based platforms) to increase nuclear deterrence by reducing the eventuality of an enemy